

Microsoft Releases Mash-up Tool

Popfly is a mash-up tool released by Microsoft—an online visual tool-set for building Web pages, widgets and mash-ups. In the “Popfly Space” community, content creators can host, share, remix, and comment on their Web pages or mash-ups with other members



CISCO Into Social Networking

CISCO is going to develop technology for social networking sites. They recently bought Five Across, a software company specialising in social networking, and are now buying resources worth \$2.9 billion from videoconferencing major WebEx Communications



Enter

Shawar Ali Actor

Ali started off his career as a model, but didn't quite make it to limelight until *Hawas* was out. Other recent movies in which he has starred include *Amar Hoshi Shahib Ho Gaya* and *Yahan Ke Hum Sikander*.

Technology to you is....

...Very important. You cannot live without it. A couple of hours ago I was in Delhi and am now in Mumbai. I was connected during the transit, all thanks to technology.

What gadgets do you use?

I have a laptop, a PlayStation, a Nokia mobile phone, a digital camera, an iPod... the iPod is the latest addition to my collection.

What would be your dream gadget be?

I would like to have a video conferencing phone so that I can see the caller at the other end. I would like to see my girlfriend when she calls me...you know!

What do you do online?

I e-mail, send my photos to studios, I have my own Web site, and I don't chat. Also, Internet banking is really so much more convenient than going to the bank.

Any instance where technology has helped you?

There was a day when my family was in dire need of money. Thanks to technology, I could transfer the funds to their accounts in minutes.

ABOUT TIME

Puma To Stalk Santa Rosa

The silicon market is all heated up right now, with new chips and platforms lined up for release. May 9, Intel launched their Santa Rosa mobile platform, and rivals AMD gave out details of their Puma mobile platform, expected in the market by mid-2008. It seems AMD's primary reason for announcing Puma was to take on Intel's Santa Rosa and the upcoming Montevina platform. AMD has finally started developments specifically for the mobile platform from the ground up.

Since the first-generation Centrino, Intel has placed an emphasis on adding new technologies such as cool running, Turbo Memory, and other features including power savings and longer battery life. Santa Rosa will sport an Intel Core 2 Duo 64-bit Merom-based 65nm processor, later to be replaced with 45nm chips. Opposed to that, AMD is gearing towards enhancing performance without compromising on battery life. Puma will have their first-ever microprocessor, codenamed Griffin, specifically designed for mobile platforms, with two Turion 64 X2 cores on a 65nm chip, a revamped Northbridge with a HyperTransport 3

controller, and a reworked onboard DDR2 memory controller.

Griffin's cores are located on separate planes, and any one of eleven independent power states (eight frequency

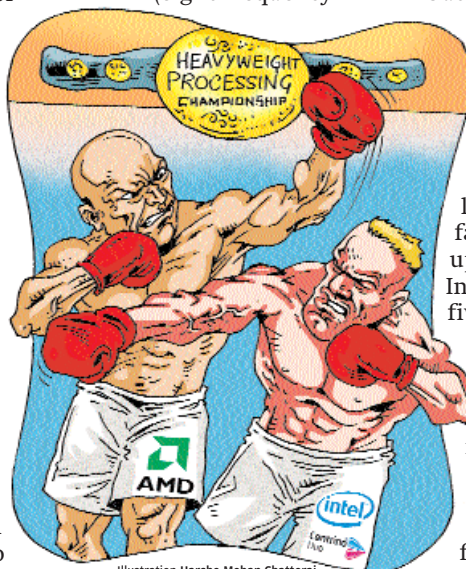


Illustration Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

settings, halt, “deep sleep,” and “deeper sleep” states) are functional for either of the cores, made possible through the memory controller. Santa Rosa includes Turbo Memory (code-named Robson) technology offering 20 per cent time reduction in booting, half the time for loading most-used programs, and more. Switching off of cores when not required can be achieved even with the memory manager working at low voltage. This feature is not that very different from what is offered with

Intel's Core 2 Duos. However, without our having tested them, it's too early to talk performance.

In Santa Rosa, Intel's Mobile 965 chipset supports DX10 graphics, but drivers won't be

available till the end of Q2 2007. R Sivakumar, managing director, Intel (South Asia) stated that the Centrino Duo platform powering consumer laptops will allow for faster digital content uploads from the Internet, delivering up to five times the performance needed for such tasks as downloads, and twice the wireless access range.

In India, Wi-Fi networks at offices and home are set up only for those who need them. On the other hand, WiMAX implementation, initiated in Pune earlier this year, will go on to six more cities. The next-gen Wireless-N card, code-named “Kedron,” provides 802.11n capability in addition to 802.11a/b/g in Santa Rosa. But 802.11n is yet to be ratified by the IEEE; in June, the Wi-Fi alliance will start certifying products using the 802.11n standard. The implementation of this standard will therefore take some time.

With the fourth generation Santa Rosa platform, Intel has always